MODULE 30 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Practice exam 3 – twenty questions

The hardest of the three. Twenty more fresh topics, same 6/4/4/4/2 weighting.

DOMAIN All five WEIGHT 100% MODULE 30 of 31

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> A warehouse with AUTO_SUSPEND set to 30 seconds serves a job that runs one three-second query every two minutes, for eight hours a day.

What is the most likely effect on cost?

A Minimal. Per-second billing means roughly 24 minutes of compute is billed per day.

B Minimal, because queries under 60 seconds are not billed at all.

C High, because a 30-second auto-suspend keeps the warehouse running continuously.

D High. Each resume bills a 60-second minimum, so about 240 minutes are billed for 12 minutes of work.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely effect on cost?

A Minimal. 24 minutes billed.

Applies per-second billing and ignores the minimum. It would be right if the warehouse never suspended.

B Queries under 60 seconds are free.

Inverts the rule. The 60-second minimum is a floor on billing, not an exemption from it.

C It runs continuously.

A 30-second auto-suspend on a job running every two minutes means it suspends between every run.

D 240 minutes billed for 12 minutes of work.

240 resumes a day, each billing a 60-second minimum. Lengthening auto-suspend is cheaper, not more expensive.

ON THE EXAM

Module 1. The counter-intuitive fix: a longer auto-suspend costs less here, and also keeps the warehouse cache warm.

> A healthcare analytics firm will store patient records subject to HIPAA. They also need customer-managed encryption keys and private connectivity from their VPC.

What is the minimum edition?

A Enterprise, since it includes all governance features.

B Business Critical, which adds PHI support, Tri-Secret Secure and PrivateLink.

C Standard, with masking policies applied to the sensitive columns.

D Virtual Private Snowflake, which is the only edition supporting HIPAA.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the minimum edition?

A Enterprise.

Has masking and classification, and none of the three requirements here. All are Business Critical features.

B Business Critical.

PHI and HIPAA support, Tri-Secret Secure for customer-managed keys, and PrivateLink all arrive together at this tier.

C Standard with masking.

Masking policies are Enterprise, not Standard. And masking does not satisfy a compliance or connectivity requirement.

D VPS only.

Business Critical supports HIPAA. VPS adds dedicated hardware and loses Marketplace access.

ON THE EXAM

Module 2. Three requirements, all landing on the same tier. PHI, customer-managed keys and PrivateLink are the Business Critical trio.

> A 30 TB table has a wide unused text column. A team drops the column expecting storage costs to fall. Three weeks later, with almost no DML on the table, storage is unchanged.

Why?

A Time Travel retains the pre-drop version, and storage will fall when retention expires.

B The column was moved to Fail-safe and will be released after seven days.

C Micro-partitions are immutable. DROP COLUMN is a metadata change, and the data stays until partitions are rewritten.

D Storage is billed on uncompressed logical size, which a dropped column does not change.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Time Travel holds the old version.

Attractive, and Time Travel does cost storage. But even after it expired, the dropped column's data would remain in those partitions.

B It is in Fail-safe.

Fail-safe covers dropped tables and historical versions, not a column inside a live table. Seven days have long passed.

C Immutability. DROP COLUMN is metadata only.

Documented behaviour. Snowflake does not rewrite every partition to remove a column, so the data remains until they are rewritten anyway.

D Billed on logical size.

Storage is billed on compressed size. Logical size is not the billing basis.

ON THE EXAM

Module 3. Immutability cuts both ways: it is why Time Travel works, and why dropping a column reclaims nothing.

> A team needs Snowflake to both read and write Apache Iceberg tables, with full platform support including Time Travel and cloning.

Which configuration is required?

A Iceberg tables with Snowflake as the catalog.

B Iceberg tables using an external catalog such as AWS Glue.

C External tables over the Iceberg data files.

D A catalog integration alone, which enables read-write on any Iceberg table.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which configuration is required?

A Snowflake as the catalog.

Snowflake-managed Iceberg tables are read-write with full platform support, including Time Travel and cloning.

B An external catalog.

Externally managed Iceberg tables are read-only from Snowflake. Another engine owns the writes.

C External tables.

Read-only, and a different feature. External tables read files; they are not Iceberg tables.

D A catalog integration alone.

A catalog integration connects to an external catalog, which is the read-only flavour. It does not confer write access.

ON THE EXAM

Module 4. The two Iceberg flavours differ on one thing: who owns the writes. Snowflake as catalog is the read-write one.

> A new analyst cannot connect from a client on the corporate network; the connection times out. Colleagues on the same network connect normally, and the analyst can sign in to Snowsight in a browser.

What is the most appropriate first step?

A Add the analyst's IP to a network policy allowed list.

B Switch the analyst to the SQL API, which avoids proxy problems.

C Reinstall the driver, since automatic upgrades were disabled from SnowSQL 1.3.0.

D Run SnowCD, the connectivity diagnostic tool, to identify which host or port is unreachable.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most appropriate first step?

A Add the IP to a network policy.

A network policy blocks with an explicit denial, not a timeout. Colleagues on the same network connect fine.

B Switch to the SQL API.

Works around the symptom without diagnosing it, and changes the analyst's tooling permanently.

C Reinstall the driver.

True that upgrades were disabled from 1.3.0, and nothing suggests a version problem. A true statement that answers nothing.

D Run SnowCD.

A diagnostic rather than a way to connect. It reports which hosts and ports are unreachable, which is exactly what is unknown.

ON THE EXAM

Module 5. SnowCD is the odd row in the connectivity table: not a way to connect, but a way to find out why you cannot.

> A security review finds that every user in a new account can call Cortex AI functions. Nobody granted anything, and the security team assumed Cortex was disabled until enabled.

What is the explanation and the remedy?

A Cortex inherits ACCOUNTADMIN by default. Restrict ACCOUNTADMIN membership.

B Someone granted CORTEX_USER to each user directly. Revoke it from the users.

C CORTEX_USER and USE AI FUNCTIONS are granted to PUBLIC by default. Revoke from PUBLIC, then grant to specific roles.

D Cortex is enabled per warehouse. Disable it on all but one warehouse.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the explanation and the remedy?

A It inherits ACCOUNTADMIN.

Invented. Access comes from a database role plus an account privilege, both held via PUBLIC.

B Granted to each user directly.

Database roles cannot be granted to users at all, so this could never have happened.

C Both granted to PUBLIC by default.

PUBLIC is granted automatically to every user and role, so Cortex has been available since the account was created.

D Enabled per warehouse.

Warehouses supply compute. They are not an access control boundary for any feature.

ON THE EXAM

Module 6. 'Nobody granted anything' is the phrase. Nothing was enabled, because it was on from account creation.

> An engineer creates a database and several tables while their session role is ACCOUNTADMIN. A custom role hierarchy exists with its top role granted to SYSADMIN. The data team, using roles beneath SYSADMIN, cannot see the new objects.

Why, and what is the fix?

A ACCOUNTADMIN objects are hidden by design. Drop and recreate them under SYSADMIN.

B Privileges are inherited upward, not downward. Transfer ownership with GRANT OWNERSHIP to a role in the hierarchy.

C The team needs SELECT granted on each table. Ownership does not affect visibility.

D Their sessions must be restarted, since role changes take effect only on reconnect.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why, and what is the fix?

A Hidden by design. Drop and recreate.

Not hidden by design, and dropping a populated database is drastic when ownership can be transferred.

B Inheritance is upward. Transfer ownership.

ACCOUNTADMIN is not a superuser. Granting role X to role Y gives Y the privileges, so nothing flows downward.

C Grant SELECT on each table.

Restores reading and leaves ACCOUNTADMIN owning production objects, so the problem recurs with every new table.

D Restart sessions.

Changes nothing. No privilege exists to refresh.

ON THE EXAM

Module 8. Objects are owned by the role active at creation. This is why 'do not make ACCOUNTADMIN a default role' is documented advice.

> An unattended orchestration tool authenticates with a username and password. After a behaviour change bundle, its sign-ins fail while interactive Snowsight sessions are unaffected.

What is the correct fix?

A Create the identity as TYPE = SERVICE and authenticate with key-pair, OAuth, a PAT or workload identity federation.

B Store an MFA push approval in the tool's configuration so it can complete the second factor.

C Grant the tool's user ACCOUNTADMIN, which is exempt from authentication policies.

D Move the tool to SSO, so federated authentication bypasses the requirement.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct fix?

A TYPE = SERVICE with key-pair, OAuth, PAT or WIF.

Service users are exempt from MFA enforcement and cannot use passwords. The documented answer for programmatic access.

B Store the MFA approval.

Not a documented pattern, and storing a second factor beside the first defeats the point of having two.

C Grant ACCOUNTADMIN.

Roles govern what you may do after authenticating. They exempt nobody from authenticating.

D Move to SSO.

SSO users are genuinely exempt from the Snowsight enforcement, and SSO is an interactive browser flow an unattended job cannot complete.

ON THE EXAM

Module 9. 'Interactive sessions unaffected' is the clue: MFA enforcement targets password sign-ins by human users.

> A masking policy hashes an email column for the analyst role. An analyst reports that a join between two tables on that email column now returns almost no rows, and a WHERE clause filtering to a known address returns nothing.

What is happening?

A. A row access policy must have been applied at the same time.

B. The masking policy is misconfigured and is filtering rows as well as values.

C. Masking is applied wherever the column is referenced, including JOIN and WHERE predicates.

D. Masked columns cannot be used in joins, so the query should have raised an error.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is happening?

A. A row access policy too.
Would explain missing rows, and would not explain a WHERE clause failing on a value known to exist.

B. Misconfigured, filtering rows.
Masking policies act on column values only. Removing rows is what a row access policy does.

C. Masking applies in JOIN and WHERE too.
Documented and deliberate. The join compares hashes to plain text, and the WHERE compares a hash to a literal.

D. Masked columns cannot be joined.
They can be. The join runs and matches nothing, which is why there is no error to help diagnose it.

ON THE EXAM

Module 10. Deliberate design: if masking applied only to output, values could be recovered by filtering for them one at a time.

> A resource monitor's suspend trigger fires at 11:00 on the fifth of a monthly interval. An engineer runs ALTER WAREHOUSE ... RESUME, which appears to succeed, and the warehouse suspends again seconds later.

What will restore service?

A Nothing until the first of next month, when the interval resets.

B Changing the trigger to SUSPEND_IMMEDIATE, which releases the current suspension.

C Resizing the warehouse, which the monitor treats as a new object.

D Increasing the credit quota, raising the suspend threshold, unassigning the warehouse, or dropping the monitor.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What will restore service?

A Nothing until next month.

The next interval is one of five remedies, not the only one. Twenty-five days of downtime is not the answer.

B Switch to SUSPEND_IMMEDIATE.

Changes how future suspensions behave, and makes them harsher. It does not release the current one.

C Resize the warehouse.

Invented. Resizing does not create a new object, and the monitor assignment persists.

D Raise quota or threshold, unassign, or drop the monitor.

Four of the five documented ways to release a suspension. The fifth is waiting for the next interval.

ON THE EXAM

Module 11. RESUME appearing to succeed then failing again is the fingerprint: the trigger is still active.

> A nightly file set must be loaded into three different tables, with columns cast and reordered for one of them. Four engineers run the pipeline on rotation. An engineer proposes staging the files on the first table's table stage.

What is wrong?

A Table stages serve one table, cannot be granted to other users, and do not support transformation during load.

B Table stages accept only one file per load, so the set must be combined first.

C Nothing, provided each engineer is granted USAGE on the table stage.

D Table stages cannot hold CSV. Only named stages support structured formats.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is wrong?

A Three restrictions, all of which apply here.

Multiple tables, multiple users, and transformation during load. Every one is something a table stage cannot do.

B One file per load.

Invented. Any stage type holds many files, and loading many at once is what gives you parallelism.

C Grant USAGE to each engineer.

A table stage is not a database object and has no grantable privileges. There is nothing to grant on.

D Table stages cannot hold CSV.

All stage types hold any supported format. Format is a property of the file and the COPY, not the stage.

ON THE EXAM

Module 13. Every table stage restriction follows from one fact: it is not an object, so there is nothing to grant and nothing to alter.

> A partner requires a single CSV file of about 800 MB with a header row, delivered weekly to an external stage. An engineer runs COPY INTO and finds dozens of small headerless files.

Which options are needed?

A. OVERWRITE = TRUE, which replaces the many files with one combined file.

B. SINGLE = TRUE, HEADER = TRUE, and MAX_FILE_SIZE raised above its 16 MB default.

C. PARTITION BY a constant expression, forcing all rows into one partition.

D. Nothing. Unload to an internal stage instead, which always produces one file with headers.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which options are needed?

A OVERWRITE = TRUE.

Controls whether existing files at the target are replaced. It does not combine output into one file.

B SINGLE, HEADER, and a raised MAX_FILE_SIZE.

Three defaults, three symptoms. SINGLE is FALSE, HEADER is FALSE, and 800 MB exceeds the 16 MB default.

C PARTITION BY a constant.

Partitioning splits output into more files, not fewer, and cannot omit the partition column from them.

D Unload to an internal stage.

Stage type does not change file count or headers. The same defaults apply wherever you unload to.

ON THE EXAM

Module 14. Every symptom traces to a default nobody chose, and the 16 MB maximum is the one people never expect.

> A Kafka connector is configured with snowflake.ingestion.method set to SNOWPIPE and snowflake.enable.schematization set to TRUE. Messages arrive correctly, but every target table has only RECORD_CONTENT and RECORD_METADATA columns.

Why?

A ENABLE_SCHEMA_EVOLUTION defaults to TRUE and must be disabled first.

B JSON cannot be schematized. Only Avro carries enough type information.

C The connector needs a storage integration before it can create columns.

D Schema detection and evolution works only with SNOWPIPE_STREAMING, not with file-based Snowpipe.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Disable ENABLE_SCHEMA_EVOLUTION.

Backwards, and it defaults to FALSE. It must be set to TRUE, by a role with OWNERSHIP on the table.

B Only Avro can be schematized.

JSON schematizes perfectly well. The ingestion method is the constraint, not the message format.

C A storage integration is needed.

Storage integrations serve external stages. Nothing here reads cloud object storage.

D It works only with SNOWPIPE_STREAMING.

Documented explicitly. The file-based Snowpipe method does not support schema detection and evolution at all.

ON THE EXAM

Module 16. The files-versus-rows split again. Only the row-based path can shape a table to the data.

> A task is scheduled every five minutes with OVERLAP_POLICY left at its default. One run takes eleven minutes. A team asks what happened to the runs scheduled during it.

What happened?

A. They queued and ran back to back once the long run finished.

B. They ran concurrently, since tasks default to allowing overlap.

C. Those scheduled times were skipped, because the default policy is NO_OVERLAP.

D. The task was auto-suspended after the second missed run.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What happened?

A They queued and ran back to back.

Under NO_OVERLAP the scheduled time is skipped, not deferred. Nothing accumulates in a queue.

B They ran concurrently.

Inverts the default. Overlap must be permitted explicitly with ALLOW_CHILD_OVERLAP or ALLOW_ALL_OVERLAP.

C Skipped, because NO_OVERLAP is the default.

If a task is still running when the next scheduled time arrives, that scheduled time is skipped.

D Auto-suspended after missed runs.

SUSPEND_TASK_AFTER_NUM_FAILURES counts failures. A skipped run is not a failure.

ON THE EXAM

Module 15. Skipped, not deferred. OVERLAP_POLICY replaces the deprecated ALLOW_OVERLAPPING_EXECUTION, so recognise both names.

> An analytics team reports that the first two or three queries after any idle period take four times longer than usual, then everything is fast. The queries vary, so the result cache does not apply. AUTO_SUSPEND is 60 seconds.

What is happening?

A Suspending drops the warehouse local disk cache. A longer auto-suspend preserves it, at the cost of idle credits.

B Auto-resume takes several minutes, so the first queries wait for the warehouse.

C The metadata cache is rebuilt on resume, which the first queries wait for.

D The 60-second billing minimum throttles the first queries after a resume.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is happening?

A The local disk cache is dropped on suspend.

Documented. The next queries re-read from storage until the cache warms again, which is the other half of the auto-suspend trade.

B Auto-resume takes minutes.

Resume is typically a second or two, and it would affect only the first query rather than the first two or three.

C The metadata cache is rebuilt.

The metadata cache lives in cloud services and survives suspension entirely. Only the warehouse cache is lost.

D The 60-second minimum throttles queries.

A billing rule, not a performance one. It affects what you pay, never how fast a query runs.

ON THE EXAM

Module 18. C is the best distractor: a real cache, placed in the wrong layer. Two of the three survive suspension.

> A query combines twelve monthly partitions of a table using UNION between each pair. Rows cannot appear in two months. Query Profile shows UnionAll operators with an Aggregate above them taking 47 percent of execution time. The SQL contains no GROUP BY.

What is that Aggregate doing?

A Computing statistics for the optimiser, which cannot be avoided.

B Duplicate elimination, because UNION deduplicates. Use UNION ALL.

C Populating the result cache, which can be disabled.

D Partition pruning across the twelve scans, which a clustering key would remove.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is that Aggregate doing?

A Optimiser statistics.

Statistics come from micro-partition metadata, not from a runtime operator consuming 47% of a query.

B Duplicate elimination. Use UNION ALL.

The documented signature: a UnionAll with an unexpected Aggregate above it. Three characters remove 47% of the work.

C Populating the result cache.

Not an operator in the tree, and disabling it would make repeat runs slower rather than faster.

D Partition pruning.

Pruning happens at the TableScan using metadata, before any data is read. It never appears as an Aggregate.

ON THE EXAM

Module 19. 'No GROUP BY' is the whole clue. An Aggregate you did not ask for is doing work you did not know you requested.

> A team enables the Query Acceleration Service on a warehouse. They then query ACCOUNT_USAGE.QUERY_ACCELERATION_ELIGIBLE expecting to see their accelerated queries, and the view returns nothing.

What does that mean?

A QAS failed to enable. Check ENABLE_QUERY_ACCELERATION on the warehouse.

B The account is not on Enterprise Edition, so the view is empty.

C The view lists only eligible queries not yet accelerated. Once QAS works, they disappear from it.

D The view populates only after the maximum scale factor is set above zero.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What does that mean?

A QAS failed to enable.

Worth checking, and an empty view is the expected result of QAS working rather than failing.

B Not on Enterprise.

QAS could not have been enabled at all without Enterprise. The scenario says it was.

C It lists only queries not yet accelerated.

Documented. An empty result looks like a problem and is usually success. Latency is also up to 180 minutes.

D Needs a scale factor above zero.

The scale factor caps how much compute may be leased. It does not gate the view.

ON THE EXAM

Module 20. An empty result that means success is unusual enough to be worth remembering. Latency here is up to 180 minutes.

> A pipeline loads device telemetry as JSON into a VARIANT column. Most documents load. A few devices producing very long event histories in a single message fail. The JSON validates correctly and the file format is confirmed.

What is the most likely cause?

A Deeply nested JSON requires ENABLE_SCHEMA_EVOLUTION on the target table.

B PARSE_JSON cannot handle arrays with more than 1,000 elements.

C MATCH_BY_COLUMN_NAME is required, since VARIANT columns match by name.

D The documents exceed the 16 MB VARIANT limit. Split each message into several rows.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely cause?

A Nesting needs schema evolution.

Schema evolution adds columns as sources change. It says nothing about the size or depth of one document.

B A 1,000-element array cap.

Invented. There is no element-count limit, only the overall size limit.

C MATCH_BY_COLUMN_NAME.

Maps staged columns to target columns by name. It does not affect whether a document fits in a VARIANT.

D They exceed the 16 MB VARIANT limit.

VARIANT is capped at 16 MB per row, compressed. Long event histories in one message is how that limit is reached.

ON THE EXAM

Module 21. 'Most load, a few fail, and those few are the largest' is the shape of a size limit rather than a format problem.

> Two retailers want to know how many customers they have in common and how those customers behaved, without either seeing the other's customer records or identifiers.

What fits?

A Each shares a secure view over hashed email addresses with the other.

B A data clean room, where linked data is reachable only through approved templates.

C A reader account for each party, isolating the data from both organisations.

D A listing on the Marketplace, restricted to the two accounts.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What fits?

A Secure views over hashed emails.

A share grants read access to every row. Hashes can be matched against a known list, so identifiers stay exposed.

B A data clean room.

Data linked in cannot be queried or viewed directly by either party. Join and column policies constrain what may be matched and returned.

C Reader accounts.

For consumers with no Snowflake account. Both parties are customers, and it isolates nothing.

D A private listing.

Still a share, so it grants read access to rows. Restricting who receives it does not stop them reading it.

ON THE EXAM

Module 24. 'Neither may see the other's identifiers' rules out every sharing option, because a share grants read access by definition.

> A company on Standard Edition has replicated a production database to another region for eight months and queries it for reporting. During a regional outage they attempt to promote the secondary so writes can continue. The statement fails.

Why?

A Failover and failback require Business Critical. Database replication alone is Standard and gives a read-only secondary.

B The secondary must be refreshed immediately before promotion, and the primary is unreachable.

C Promotion requires ORGADMIN, which the team was not using.

D Secondary databases can never be promoted. A new primary must be built from a clone.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Failover needs Business Critical.

The documented boundary. Standard replicates a database and gives a read-only secondary; promoting it is a Business Critical capability.

B A refresh is required first.

Good practice before a planned failover, and not what blocks this. An unplanned failover accepts data loss to the last refresh.

C Promotion requires ORGADMIN.

Account administrators manage failover groups. ORGADMIN handles organization-level tasks such as creating accounts.

D Secondaries can never be promoted.

Promotion is exactly what failover is. It simply requires the right edition.

ON THE EXAM

Modules 2 and 25. Eight months of successful replication proves nothing about failover. They sit on opposite sides of the line.

Answer key and domain map

Q	ANSWER	DOMAIN AND TOPIC
1-3	D, B, C	D1: 60-second minimum, Business Critical trio, immutability and DROP COLUMN
4-6	A, D, C	D1: Iceberg flavours, SnowCD, Cortex granted to PUBLIC
7-10	B, A, C, D	D2: ownership and upward inheritance, TYPE = SERVICE, masking in predicates, monitor recovery
11-14	A, B, D, C	D3: table stage restrictions, unload defaults, Kafka schematization, OVERLAP_POLICY
15-18	A, B, C, D	D4: warehouse cache on suspend, UNION without ALL, QAS eligible view, VARIANT 16 MB
19-20	B, A	D5: clean room, failover edition boundary

ON THE EXAM

Five of each letter, no two adjacent questions sharing an answer. Sixty distinct topics across the three exams.

After three exams

- **Sixty distinct topics tested** across the three papers, with no repeats. Your pattern across all three is the real signal.
- **A domain missed in two or three exams** needs the module rewatched. Missed in one is noise.
- **This set was the hardest deliberately.** A lower score here than on exam 1 is expected, not a warning.
- **The day before:** rewatch module 26, the confusion pairs, and skim module 27's six shapes. Nothing new.
- **Confirm the exam format** on Snowflake's own page before booking. Question count, time and fee do change.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next: module 00, the introduction. Built last so its module list reads the real runtimes from every manifest.